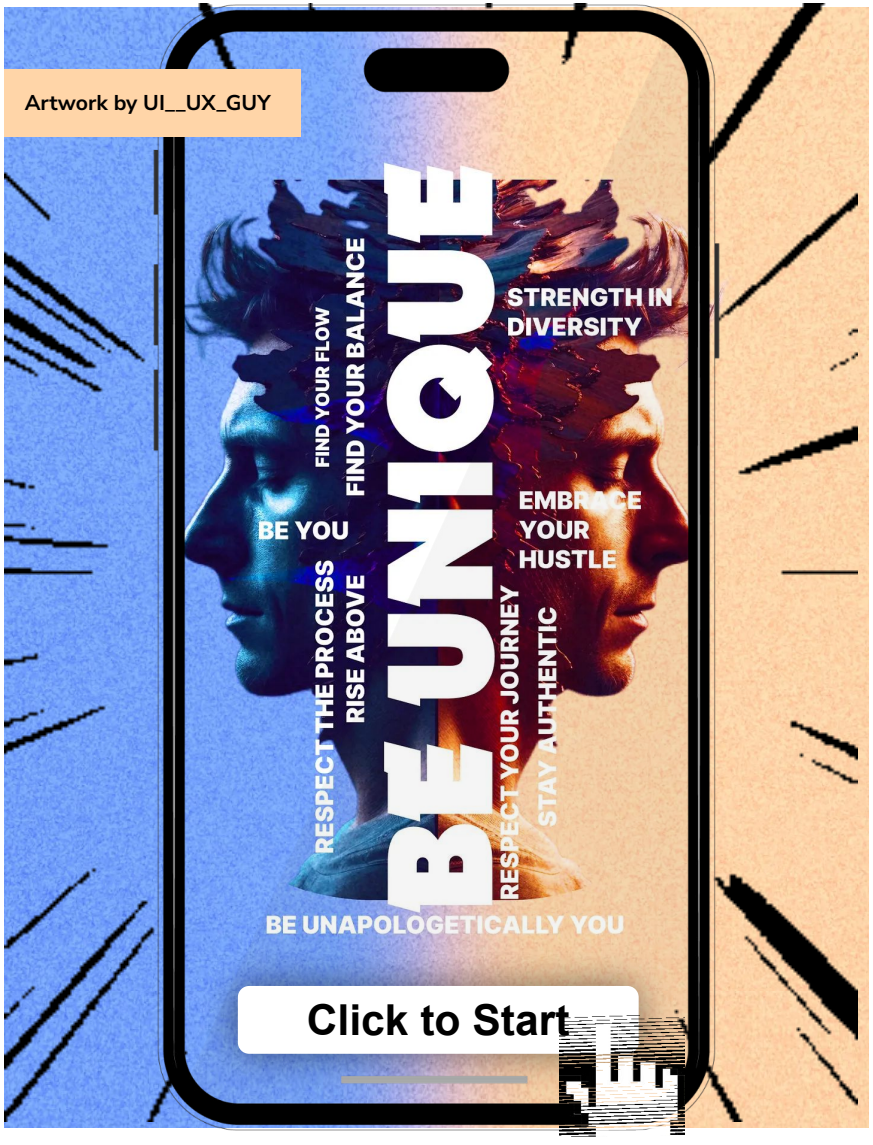



UX 300 SEMESTER 2 PROJECT

# MANIFESTO IN MOTION

## DELIVERABLES:

**1. Discover:** Manifesto Translation, Focused Research, Research Findings

**2. Define:** Persona, Problem Frame & Statement, Experience Planning, Annotated Wireframes

**3. Design:** Final UI / Digital Experience, Interactive Prototype, Promotional Video, Mockups

**4. Debrief:** Case study

## SUBMISSION DEADLINES:

Summative Submission

**Week 6: Canvas uploads**

**Sunday, 25 October 22:00**

Capstone Presentations:

**Week 7: 28/9 October In Class (Canvas uploads)**

Laudette Sass
Laudette@openwindow.co.za

## INTRODUCTION

**This is your final UX project.**

Throughout the year, you have been asked to solve problems, work within constraints, respond to users, collaborate with others and defend your design decisions. This project asks something slightly different:

**What kind of UX designer do you want to be?**

During Term 3, you developed your own Design Manifesto; a statement of the values, principles and beliefs that shape the way you approach design. Your capstone project is your opportunity to put that manifesto into practice.

You will identify a problem, opportunity or area that you genuinely care about and develop a UX project that reflects both your abilities as a designer and your personal design position.

The final outcome is deliberately open-ended. You may create a digital product, service, platform, connected experience, speculative concept or another appropriate UX intervention.

**What you create is up to you.**

How well you justify it is not.

You have six weeks to complete the project. This is a sprint-paced capstone, so you will need to work independently, make decisions quickly and prioritise the work that creates the most value.

## OUTCOMES

**On completion of this project, students should be able to:**

- Independently identify and investigate a meaningful UX problem or opportunity.
- Translate personal design values and principles into practical design decisions.
- Use appropriate research to understand users, context and existing solutions.
- Define a focused and achievable UX direction.
- Develop, communicate and justify a user-centred experience.
- Produce and refine an appropriate high-fidelity digital interface or experience.
- Critically reflect on your process and design decisions.
- Professionally present and defend your work.

# PROJECT BRIEF

## WHAT YOU NEED TO DO

Use your Design Manifesto as the starting point for an original UX project.

Select a subject, problem or opportunity that you care about and develop an experience that demonstrates both:

1. **Your ability as a UX designer, and**
2. **Your identity and position as a designer.**

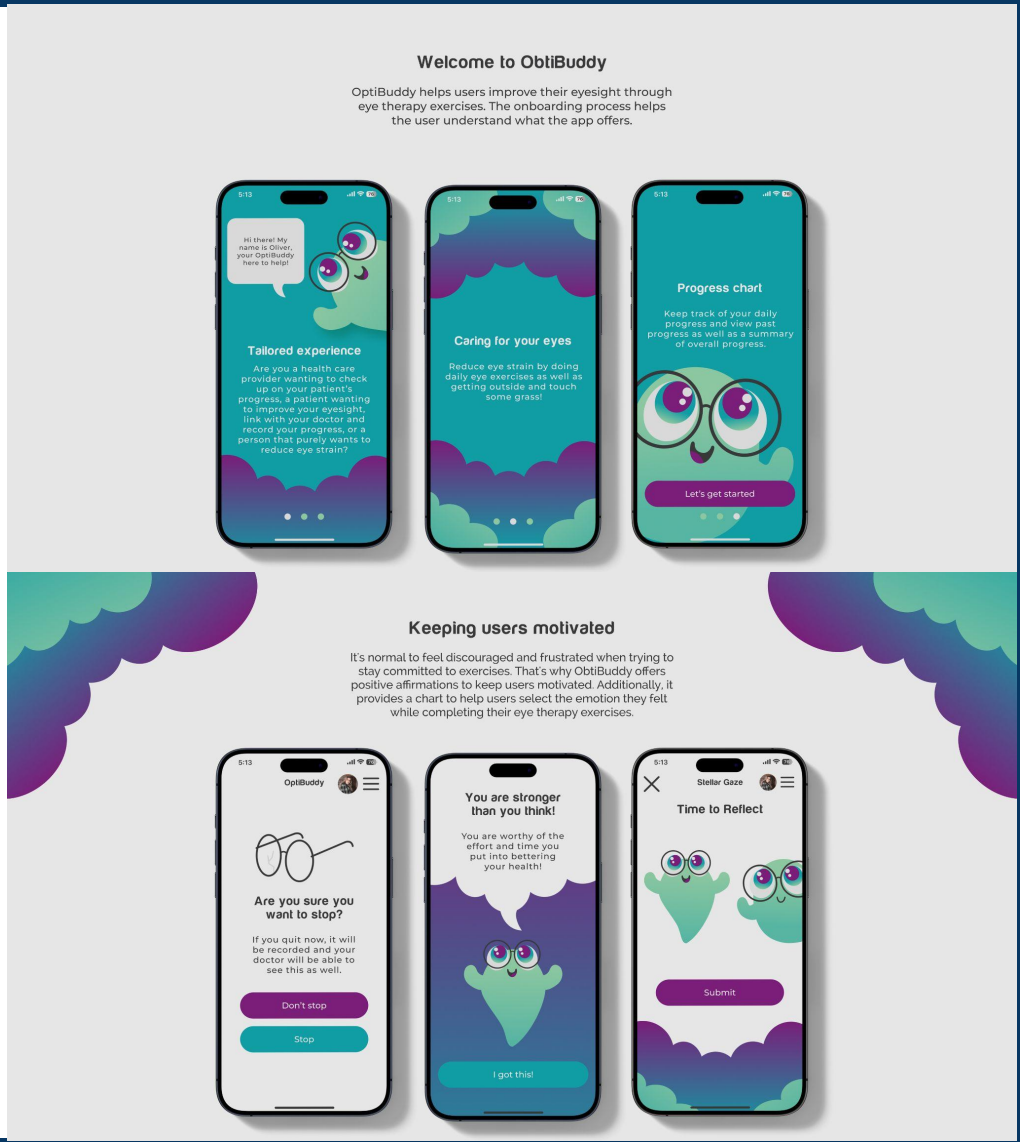
Your project may respond to an existing problem, improve an existing experience, explore a new opportunity or propose a speculative future.

Regardless of the direction you choose, your project must:

- → address a clearly defined user or experience need;
- → be supported by research;
- → identify a clear target user;
- → demonstrate a considered UX process;
- → include a meaningful digital interface or touchpoint;
- → show development from early thinking to final execution;
- → clearly connect back to your Design Manifesto; and
- → be presented as a professional capstone project.

Your manifesto should not simply appear as a page at the beginning of your project.

**It should be visible in the decisions you make.**



# PROJECT SYNOPSIS

**Create an original UX project that demonstrates who you are as a designer by translating your Design Manifesto into a researched, considered and professionally executed user experience.**

## YOU WILL BE REQUIRED TO CREATE THE FOLLOWING FOR THE PROJECT:

### 1. Manifesto Connection
A clear explanation of how your manifesto informs the project and key design decisions.

### 2. Research & Insights
Focused research appropriate to your chosen problem, supported by clear findings and insights.

### 3. Persona
A focused, research-informed representation of your primary user.

### 4. Problem Frame, Problem Statement & Project Direction
A clear problem/opportunity statement, project goal and defined scope.

### 5. Experience Planning
Appropriate UX planning showing how the experience should work.

### 6. Annotated Wireframes
Wireframes showing structure, functionality, interactions and design reasoning.

### 7. Final UI / Experience
A refined set of final interface screens or digital touchpoints.

### 8. Interactive Prototype
A prototype that communicates the core experience and important interactions.

### 9. Promotional Video
A short video presenting the concept and demonstrating the final experience.

### 10. Case Study
Communicate your full design process and reasoning clearly in a professional, single-page project case study.

### 11. Mockups
Present your final solution in realistic, polished visual contexts without introducing new functionality.

### 12. Final Presentation
An in-person presentation and defence of your project.

**Presentations will happen in week 7, after the assignment submission**

# 1. DISCOVER

**Understand what you are designing and why**

The freedom of this project does not mean that you should immediately start designing.

Your first task is to investigate the area you have chosen and determine whether there is a meaningful problem or opportunity worth addressing.

Your research should be focused rather than exhaustive. You only have six weeks, so select research methods that will help you make better design decisions.

The purpose of the Discover phase is to understand:

→ the context;
→ the people involved;
→ existing behaviours and frustrations;
→ current solutions or competitors;
→ relevant opportunities;
→ and why this project matters to you.

## RESEARCH DELIVERABLES

A) Project Direction

PDF | Dimensions: W:1920 x H:1080

B) Manifesto Translation

PDF | Dimensions: W:1920 x H:1080

C) Focused Research

PDF | Dimensions: W:1920 x H:1080

D) Research Findings

PDF | Dimensions: W:1920 x H:1080

## A) PROJECT DIRECTION

Briefly introduce:

- the area you want to explore;
- why you selected it;
- who may be affected by it;
- and why it matters.

## B) MANIFESTO TRANSLATION

Identify the key principles from your Design Manifesto that will guide this project. Explain how these principles could influence the way you research, design or evaluate the experience.

## C) FOCUSED RESEARCH

Conduct research appropriate to your project.

Your research may include methods such as:
Interviews; observation; contextual enquiry; surveys; competitor or precedent analysis; literature or secondary research; expert input; existing user feedback; behavioural analysis.

Your methods should be selected because they are useful to the project; not simply because they are familiar.

## D) RESEARCH FINDINGS

Identify the most important:

FINDINGS | PATTERNS | TENSIONS | OPPORTUNITIES | INSIGHTS that will influence your project.

## 2. DEFINE

**Decide what you are actually going to solve**

Research can uncover many possible problems.

You cannot solve all of them.

The Define phase asks you to determine where you will focus your effort and what your project needs to achieve.

Your decisions should show that you can prioritise, reduce scope and establish a clear direction within the six-week sprint.

### DEFINE DELIVERABLES

A) Persona

PDF | Dimensions: W:1920 x H:1080

B) Problem Frame & Statement

PDF | Dimensions: W:1920 x H:1080

C) Experience Planning

PDF | Dimensions: W:1920 x H:1080

D) Annotated Wireframes

PDF

### A) PERSONA

Create a focused, research-informed persona representing the primary user you are designing for.

The persona should help explain:

- what they are trying to achieve;
- their relevant behaviours;
- their needs;
- their frustrations;
- and the context in which they will encounter your solution.

### B) PROBLEM FRAME & STATEMENT

Clearly define the experience problem or opportunity your project will address. Create a clear HMW question to address the problem.

Your statement should establish: who you are designing for; what needs to change; and why it matters.

### C) EXPERIENCE PLANNING

Show how the proposed experience should work. Choose the UX documentation that best suits your particular project. This could include:

- user flows;
- task flows;
- experience maps;
- journeys;
- information architecture;
- service flows;
- system diagrams;

You do not need to create every UX artefact you have ever learnt. Choose the tools that help you think.

## D) ANNOTATED WIREFRAMES

Develop wireframes for the key parts of your experience.

Annotations should explain important:

- functionality;
- interactions;
- content decisions;
- hierarchy;
- user behaviour;
- system responses;
- and design rationale.

Focus on the parts of the experience that are necessary to understand your solution.

**INCLUDE:**

**Design Development**

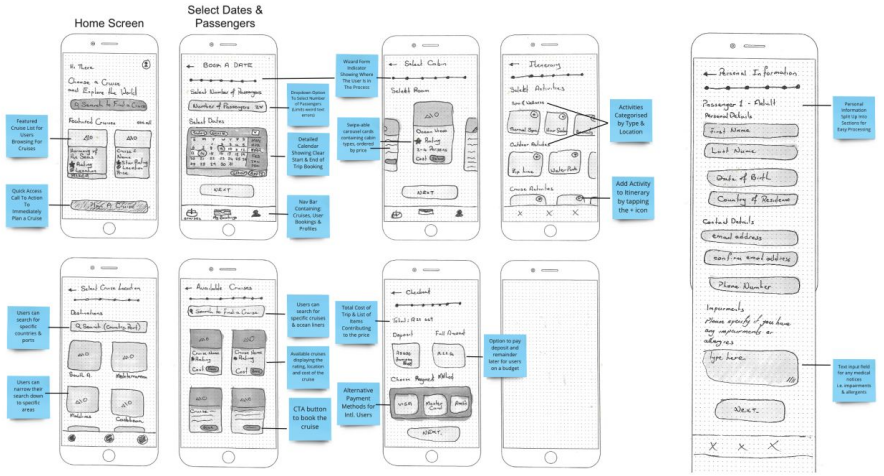
Show evidence of meaningful iteration between your initial ideas and your final solution.

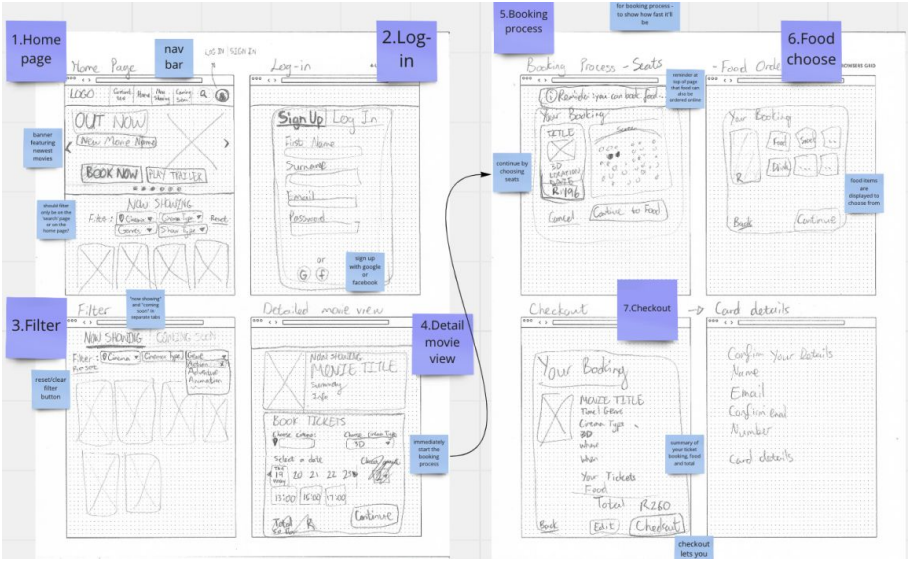
This may include:

- alternative approaches;
- design explorations;
- feedback;
- usability testing;
- iteration;
- discarded ideas;
- or significant changes in direction.

You do not need to document every small adjustment.

**Show the decisions that mattered.**



## 3. DESIGN

**Turn your position into an experience**

This phase is where your project moves from strategy into execution.

Your final solution should demonstrate a considered relationship between user needs, your research, your manifesto and the decisions you make as a designer.

You are expected to show development rather than jumping directly to polished screens.

### DESIGN DELIVERABLES

A) Final UI / Digital Experience

PNG — Own choice. Please however adhere to best practice guidelines.

B) Interactive Prototype

PDF — Clickable prototype link

C) Promotional Video

MP4 / MOV

D) 3x UI Mockups

PNG — Dimensions: W:7063px x H:5008px

### A) FINAL UI/ DIGITAL EXPERIENCE

Produce a professionally resolved final interface.

The number and type of screens will differ between projects. You should produce enough of the experience to convincingly demonstrate:

- the core user journey;
- important functionality;
- visual hierarchy;
- interaction patterns;
- content;
- states and feedback;
- accessibility considerations;
- and the overall experience.

Quality is more important than screen count.

### B) INTERACTIVE PROTOTYPE

Create a prototype that demonstrates the most important parts of the experience.

The prototype should be sufficient for someone unfamiliar with your project to understand how the proposed experience works.

### C) PROMOTIONAL VIDEO

Create a short promotional video introducing your project and showing the final experience.

The video should communicate: the problem or opportunity; the central idea; the value of the experience; and the final design in action.

Treat the video as a showcase of the project, rather than a screen-recorded walkthrough of every feature.

## 3. DESIGN

### D) DEVICE MOCKUPS

Submit 3 UI device mockups of your final UI screens. Try to showcase a variety of screens through your mockup submission. Make sure that you use the correct devices based on the screens that you've designed (iPhone vs Android & screen size). Please save your mockups on the following dimensions: **W:7063px x H:5008px or W:1080 H:1080**




**Student Work by Nicola Prinsloo (2025)**

## FINAL PRESENTATION

**Defend your work**

Your capstone will conclude with an in-person presentation on campus.

This is not simply a walkthrough of your screens.

You are expected to present the thinking behind the project, communicate its value and defend the decisions you made.

Your presentation should communicate:

- what you chose to explore and why;
- the key research that influenced the project;
- your user and their needs;
- the central design idea;
- how your manifesto influenced the experience;
- important design decisions;
- the final solution;
- and what the project says about you as a designer.

You should be prepared to answer questions and justify your decisions.

**THIS WILL HAPPEN IN WEEK 7, AFTER SUBMISSIONS.**

# 4. DEBRIEF

## A) CASE STUDY

You are expected to produce a summarised case study of your project that will act as portfolio documentation. Please pay attention to including all the relevant sections.

**Tip: make some effort with the case study design, as this will be assessed as part of your 3rd year portfolio submission at the end of the year AND there will be little time to make revisions in term 4.**

### CASE STUDY REQUIREMENTS

Screen size to use: W:1920 H:24840 (max height)

#### SECTION 1: HERO HEADER (VERY TOP SECTION OF THE CASE STUDY)

- Include a project title & app icon
- Include a project blurb (summarised app concept)
- Include a product mockup
- Please do not add your name, surname and student number or term on the case study.

#### SECTION 2: PROBLEM FRAMING

- Frame the design challenge
- Add problem statement and question
- Add solution statement

**Avoid phrases like "this brief was...", "in this brief, we had to...", or "I was tasked with...". Rather, summarise what was required and respond through the project's tone of voice or perspective.**

#### SECTION 3: RESEARCH AND DESIGN PROCESS

Provide an overview of the activities you did throughout the project's development. You can rely on research activities, diagrams, sketches, wireframes, style tiles and visual designs to elevate the project's design process. Here you need to show how the project research and planning activities helped you to get to a final solution.

**Example structure:**

- Key insights from research / research techniques
- Features of application
- Persona & user research
- User diagrams and mapping
- Sketches
- Annotated wireframes
- Style tile / UI Kit
- Visual Design and features explanation
- QR code or embedded link to prototype

**When including interface screens, it's important to explain how the features work. Don't just show, tell! Anyone reading your case study, should be able to understand the functionality and intention of your digital solution.**

#### SECTION 4: CONCLUSION AND FINAL THOUGHTS

Your conclusion and final thoughts should be written from the project's perspective, instead of your personal perspective. Avoid sentences like: 'In my personal opinion, I found this project challenging / fun / interesting..."

**NB! Reiterate how you've solved the problem identified in the problem frame through your digital interface (solution). This should be the crux of the conclusion.**

PDF | PNG | BEHANCE | Dimensions: W:1920 x H:24840 px

## SUBMISSION FORMATS

You will be submitting a **single, ZIP folder** in week 6 that contains all the activities and final deliverables. Structure the folder as follows.

🗂️ **Surname, Name_Student No._UX300_Term 4**

- 🗂️ **1. DISCOVER**
  - 📄 **A.** Project Direction (PDF)
  - 📄 **B.** Manifesto Translation ( PDF)
  - 📄 **C.** Focused Research (PDF)
  - 📄 **D.** Research Findings (PDF)
- 🗂️ **2. DEFINE**
  - 📄 **A.** Persona (PDF)
  - 📄 **B.** Problem Frame & Statement (PDF)
  - 📄 **C.** Experience Planning (PDF)
  - 📄 **D.** Annotated Wireframes (PDF)
- 🗂️ **3. DESIGN**
  - 🗂️ **A. Final UI / Digital Experience(PNGs)**
    - 📄 1. Feature screen
    - 📄 2. Feature screen
    - 📄 3. Feature screen

    *etc.*
  - 📄 **B.** A url link to your clickable prototype (PDF)
  - 📹 **C.** Promotional video (MP4)
  - 🗂️ **D. UI Device mockups (PNGs)**
    - 📄 1. Mockup 01
    - 📄 2. Mockup 02
    - 📄 3. Mockup 03
- 🗂️ **4. DEBRIEF**
  - 🗂️ **Case study (PNG upload to Behance, PDF for submission)**

**FINAL PRESENTATIONS WILL HAPPEN IN WEEK 7 AFTER SUBMISSIONS.**

# TERM OVERVIEW SEMESTER 2 THEME 4

## WEEK 1 (14 SEP - 18 SEP) — Campus

| CLASS ACTIVITIES | END OF WEEK OUTPUT / HOMEWORK |
|---|---|
| Introduction to the capstone brief<br>Moving from manifesto to project<br><br>**In Class**<br>**Students will unpack their Design Manifesto and identify:**<br>• the principles they most want to explore;<br>• subjects or problems they care about;<br>• possible users or communities;<br>• possible UX interventions;<br>• and what they want this project to say about them as a designer.<br><br>**Ideas should be interrogated for both meaning and feasibility.** | **By the end of Week 1, you should have:**<br>• Chosen your project direction<br>• Identified the relevant manifesto principles<br>• Defined the initial user/context<br>• Written an initial project intention<br>• Established a research plan<br>• Defined an achievable project scope<br><br>**Checkpoint**<br>You should be able to complete the sentence:<br><br>I am exploring _____ for _____ because _____, and this connects to my manifesto principle of _____.<br><br>**Your project direction should be committed by the end of this week.** |

## WEEK 2 (21 SEP - 25 SEP) — Online

| | |
|---|---|
| **Find out what actually matters**<br><br>**Teaching Focus**<br>• Choosing the right research methods<br>• Competitor and precedent analysis<br>• Turning findings into useful insights<br><br>Because of the short timeline, your research needs to be purposeful and selective.<br><br>You do not need large quantities of research. **You need enough evidence to make informed decisions.** | **By the end of Week 2, you should have:**<br>• Completed your primary and/or secondary research<br>• Investigated relevant existing solutions or precedents<br>• Identified key findings<br>• Synthesised your most important insights<br>• Begun identifying your primary user<br>• Identified any changes required to your original project direction<br><br>**Checkpoint**<br>**You should now be able to explain:**<br>• What you originally thought<br>• What you discovered<br>• What changed because of the research |

## WEEK 3 (28 SEP - 2 OCT) — Campus

| CLASS ACTIVITIES | END OF WEEK OUTPUT / HOMEWORK |
|---|---|
| **Decide what you are actually solving**<br>Selecting appropriate UX planning tools<br>Translating manifesto principles into design criteria<br><br>This week marks the transition from investigation into design.<br><br>By the end of Week 3, the project should no longer be open-ended. **You should know who you are designing for, what you are solving and what you intend to build.**<br><br>FORMATIVE CHECKPOINT<br><br>**Discuss in class:**<br>Your manifesto position; chosen project; research; user; problem; proposed direction<br><br>This is to determine whether the project is sufficiently focused and achievable before significant design production begins.<br><br>**Feedback received here should directly influence Week 4.** | **You should have:**<br>• Finalised research findings<br>• Persona<br>• Final problem / opportunity statement<br>• Project goal<br>• Defined project scope<br>• Prioritised key functionality or experiences<br>• Appropriate experience planning documentation<br>• Clearly defined manifesto/design principles<br><br>**Examples of planning documentation may include:**<br><br>user flows; task flows; experience maps; journeys; information architecture; service flows; system maps.<br><br>**Choose what your project requires.** |

## WEEK 4 (5 OCT - 9 OCT) — Online

| | |
|---|---|
| **Make it work before making it beautiful**<br><br>This week should focus heavily on solving the experience.<br><br>Do not spend the entire week polishing visual design while important interaction problems remain unresolved.<br><br>**ADDITIONAL CONTENT: ECOMMERCE** | • Developed the primary experience flow<br>• Completed annotated wireframes<br>• Designed important states and interactions<br>• Tested or critiqued key parts of the experience<br><br>**In-Class Critique**<br>Students should be prepared to show their work and explain:<br>• What the user is trying to achieve<br>• How the experience supports them<br>• Why specific design decisions were made<br>• How the manifesto is influencing those decisions |

# TERM OVERVIEW SEMESTER 2 THEME 4

## WEEK 5 (12 OCT - 16 OCT) — Campus

| CLASS ACTIVITIES | END OF WEEK OUTPUT / HOMEWORK |
|---|---|
| Turn the project into a finished piece of work<br><br>**Teaching Focus**<br><br>• High-fidelity refinement<br>• UI consistency and accessibility<br>• Presenting design decisions<br>• Preparing for a design defence<br><br>**Week 5 is the production sprint.**<br><br>By this stage, major structural UX changes should be limited. Your attention should move towards refining the experience and communicating it professionally. | **By the end of Week 5, you should have:**<br><br>• Final UI screens substantially complete<br>• Core prototype substantially complete<br>• Accessibility and usability details resolved<br>• Promotional video planned or in production |

## WEEK 6 (19 OCT - 23 OCT) — Online

| | |
|---|---|
| **Presentation Preparation**<br><br>Begin reducing the entire project into a clear story.<br><br>Your presentation should not attempt to show everything you did.<br><br>**Identify the decisions that best demonstrate:**<br><br>• your thinking;<br>• your UX ability;<br>• your manifesto;<br>• and the value of your final solution.<br><br>**ADDITIONAL CONTENT:**<br>**PRESENTING PORTFOLIOS**<br>**CLIENT FACING PRESENTATIONS** | SUMMATIVE SUBMISSION |

## WEEK 7 (26 OCT - 30 OCT) — Campus

| CLASS ACTIVITIES | END OF WEEK OUTPUT / HOMEWORK |
|---|---|
| **CAPSTONE PRESENTATION**<br>**Show us who you are as a UX designer**<br><br>This week concludes with the UX 300 Capstone Presentations.<br><br>Students will present their projects in person on campus and respond to questions about their research, reasoning and final design.<br><br>CAPSTONE PRESENTATION | SUBMIT THE PRESENTATION TO CANVAS |

## WEEK 8 (2 NOV - 6 NOV) — NO CLASS

| | |
|---|---|
| **PORTFOLIO WORK**<br><br>This week should focus on completing case studies for the final portfolio. There will be no class, but we can do feedback via Figma should the students want it. | |

### Sprint Principle

You are not expected to create the largest project of your degree.

You are expected to create the most intentional one.

A focused, well-researched and beautifully resolved experience will be more successful than an ambitious project that cannot be completed properly within six weeks.

## IMPORTANT DATES

### SUBMISSION DEADLINES

1. **COMPLETE PROJECT ZIP (DISCOVER, DEFINE, DESIGN, & DEBRIEF DELIVERABLES)**

   WEEK 6 TERM 4: SUNDAY 25 OCTOBER 22H00 (CANVAS UPLOAD)

2. **PROJECT PRESENTATIONS**

   WEEK 7 TERM 4: 28/9 OCTOBER 22H00 (CANVAS UPLOAD)

### PUBLIC HOLIDAYS

- THURSDAY, 24 SEPTEMBER: HERITAGE DAY (WEEK 2, ONLINE)

**Please make sure that you are aware of the above submission dates and public holidays so that you are well prepared for your submissions.**

## ACADEMIC RULES & POLICIES

For a comprehensive overview of our academic policies regarding contact sessions, attendance, punctuality, loadshedding, late submissions, extensions, plagiarism and more please visit this **link**.

**The OW Plagiarism policy and declaration can be viewed here.**

For more information please visit the **Student Code of Conduct** and the **Yearbook**.

## ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

Your project will be assessed on the quality of your thinking, your ability to apply UX knowledge independently, the execution of the final experience and your ability to communicate and defend your work.

The scale of different projects may vary considerably.

You will not receive more marks simply because your project is larger, contains more screens or includes more features.

You will be assessed on how effectively you identify, develop and resolve the project you chose.

## ASSESSMENT CRITERIA & PROJECT WEIGHTING

| Deliverables | Associated Assessment Criteria | Mark Breakdown |
|---|---|---|
| *Deliverables* | *On completion of this term students are assessed on their ability to:* | *Deliverable weighting* |
| **Manifesto Connection & Design Position** | How clearly your project reflects your manifesto, personal values and position as a UX designer. Your principles should influence actual design decisions. | **10%** |
| **Research & User Understanding** | The relevance and quality of your research, findings, insights and understanding of the user and context. | **15%** |
| **Problem Frame & Statement** | How clearly you define the problem, user, project goal, priorities and appropriate UX direction. | **10%** |
| **UX Development & Annotated Wireframes** | The quality of your experience planning, wireframes, annotations, iteration and reasoning throughout development. | **20%** |
| **Final Experience & UI Execution** | The quality, coherence, usability and professional resolution of the final interface, experience and prototype. | **20%** |
| **Promotional Video** | How effectively the video communicates and showcases the concept and final experience. | **5%** |
| **Final Presentation & Defence** | Your ability to professionally present the project, communicate its value and confidently justify your decisions in person. | **20%** |

# IMAGE, ASSET & AI USAGE GUIDELINES

This project assesses your ability to think critically and design responsibly. Your work must demonstrate original reasoning, ethical design decisions, and clear research-to-design traceability.

**What you ARE allowed to use**
**iOS screen components:** iOS 17 Design Resources
**Android screen components:** Android UI Kit (Material 3)

**Photography**

- Royalty-free stock photography (Unsplash, Pexels, StockSnap, Nappy, PikWizard, Burst, KaboomPics, Gratisography)
- AI-generated photography (generated by you)
- Your own original photography

**Illustration**

- ✔ Your own original illustrations
- ✔ AI-generated illustrations (generated by you)
- ❌ Stock illustrations are not permitted (even if royalty-free)

**Icons**

- Royalty-free icon packs (Lucide, Flaticon, TheNounProject, Icons8, Iconfinder)
- Icons must come from a single consistent pack

**Mockups**

- Device mockups are allowed (e.g. Figma Community mockup files)
- These may be used only for presentation purposes

**AI Tools (e.g. ChatGPT, image generators)**

✔ May be used for:

- UI microcopy (button labels, helper text, onboarding copy)
- Image / illustration generation (if generated by you)

❌ May NOT be used for:

- Research interpretation
- Problem framing
- Feature ideation
- ~~Wireframes~~
- ~~UI layouts~~
- Case study writing
- Reflective or analytical writing

**If AI is used to replace your thinking instead of supporting your process, this will be treated as academic misconduct.**

❌ **What is NOT allowed**

- Downloading UI kits, app templates, wireframes, or components from Figma Community
- Using stock illustrations of any kind
- ~~Using AI tools to generate design solutions~~
- Using AI to write analytical or reflective content
- Using pre-designed app screens or layouts

Your interface design must be self-generated and must emerge from:
Your research interpretation → problem frame → planning → design decisions

**A visually polished outcome that bypasses this thinking will be penalised.**

“Design is not a thing you do.
It’s a way of life.”

Alan Fletcher